

AIRIA AI GATEWAY PLATFORM

Claude Desktop via Airia Gateway

User Impersonation (Plan License) — Setup & Configuration Guide

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Gateway: sg01

User-Facing

What this guide does: Configure Claude Desktop to route inference through the Airia AI Gateway using your existing Anthropic plan subscription. Your Claude plan seat absorbs the cost — no additional API credits are required. Airia remains in the inference path for logging, model allow-lists, and governance.



How It Works

Airia's AI Gateway uses **User Impersonation** mode — your own Anthropic Bearer token is forwarded upstream to `api.anthropic.com`, alongside an Airia Gateway Key that authenticates the request to Airia. Two credentials are always in play:

YOUR ANTHROPIC OAUTH TOKEN

`sk-ant-oat01-...`

Authenticates to Anthropic and bills your plan.
Sent as `Authorization: Bearer`.

AIRIA GATEWAY KEY

`Airia-issued format`

Authenticates to the Airia gateway and identifies your tenant config. Sent as `x-airia-key`.



What You Need Before Starting

Confirm all of the following are in place before proceeding with the steps below.

- **Claude Desktop (recent version)**

Third-party inference UI requires Developer Mode to be enabled. Ensure your app is up to date.

- **Claude Code CLI — installed & logged in**

Run `/login` with your plan account (Pro/Max/Team/Enterprise). Do *not* use an API key.

- **Airia Gateway — User Impersonation configured**

Your Airia AI Gateway config must have *AI Service Authentication* set to

- **Airia Gateway Key**

Your `x-airia-key` value, issued by Airia for your tenant configuration. Have this ready before Step 2.

Use User Impersonation

- **Active Anthropic Plan Subscription**

Pro, Max, Team, or Enterprise subscription required. Inference cost will bill to this plan seat.

- **Allowed Models List (Airia side)**

Must include all intended models plus `claude-haiku-4-5` (used for background tasks). An empty list allows all models.

1 Mint Your Anthropic OAuth Token

1 Run the setup command on your local machine

1. In a terminal on your **local machine** (not over plain SSH — the OAuth callback targets localhost), run: `claude setup-token`
2. A browser window opens to `claude.ai/oauth/authorize` (scope: `user:inference`, PKCE flow). Ensure the browser profile is signed in to the correct plan account, then click **Approve**.
3. The browser redirects to a callback URL containing `?code=...&state=...`. If the CLI doesn't capture it automatically, copy the `code` value and paste it into the waiting CLI prompt. (*Some versions expect `code#state`.*)
4. The CLI prints your token: `sk-ant-oat01-...` — a long-lived (~1 year) subscription-scoped token. Copy and store it securely.

⚠ **Security note:** The `?code=...` value from the URL is a one-time authorization code — it is *not* the token. Only the CLI can exchange it (it holds the PKCE verifier). Treat your `sk-ant-oat01-...` token like a password. Anyone holding it can consume your plan quota. Do not commit it to source control. If leaked, log out/in via Claude Code and mint a new token.

2 Configure Claude Desktop

2 Connect Claude Desktop to the Airia Gateway

1. Enable Developer Mode: **Help** → **Troubleshooting** → **Enable Developer Mode** (*the app restarts and a Developer menu appears*).
2. Open **Developer** → **Configure Third-Party Inference** and select **Connection: Gateway**.
3. Enter the following credentials:

Field	Value
Gateway base URL	<code>https://sg01.gateway.airia.ai</code> (or your regional gateway)
Credential kind	Static API key
Gateway API key	Your <code>sk-ant-oat01-...</code> token from Step 1
Gateway auth scheme	<code>bearer</code> — required; plan tokens travel as <code>Authorization: Bearer</code> , not <code>x-api-key</code>
Custom inference headers	<code>x-airia-key</code> = your Airia-issued gateway key (<i>not the Anthropic token</i>)

4. **Models:** Add your primary models (e.g. `claude-sonnet-4-6`, an Opus model) and `claude-haiku-4-5`. These must match the Allowed Models list in your Airia gateway config.
5. Click **Test connection** — expect model discovery plus a short inference round-trip to succeed. Then click **Apply Changes**.

✓ **Verify Billing Landed on Your Plan**

3 **Confirm cost attribution in the Airia gateway logs**

i A passing connection test proves **connectivity** — not billing. Complete the steps below to confirm cost is correctly attributed to your plan seat.

- ✓ Confirm in the Airia gateway logs that **User** (bearer token forwarded, not an the request is attributed to **Impersonation** Airia or customer API key).
- ✓ Confirm that no balance was debited from the Airia workspace or any customer Anthropic API key.
- ✓ Screenshot the log entry as your confirmation record.

! **Troubleshooting**

Symptom	Cause	Fix
<code>401</code> from gateway — "Invalid API key"	The <code>x-airia-key</code> header contains the Anthropic token instead of the Airia gateway key.	Put the Airia-issued key in <code>x-airia-key</code> ; the Anthropic token belongs only in the Gateway API key field.

Symptom	Cause	Fix
<code>401</code> in Anthropic's error format (<code>authentication_error</code>) after Airia accepts the request	Anthropic is rejecting the <code>setup-token</code> on the direct Messages API path.	Contact Airia support and ask what token source their Integrate flow provisions.
Model error / request blocked at gateway	Requested model not in the Airia config's Allowed Models list.	Add the model to the allow-list (remember <code>claude-haiku-4-5</code>), or clear the list to allow all models.
CLI never receives the OAuth code	<code>setup-token</code> run over SSH; localhost callback can't reach the CLI.	Run locally, or use <code>ssh -L 51222:localhost:51222</code> before approving.
Pasting the <code>?code=...</code> value as the API key	Authorization code mistaken for the token.	Complete the exchange in the CLI — only the resulting <code>sk-ant-oat01-...</code> string is your credential.